to back him up from the other end. We did not get the wickets we were after in the post-lunch session, however, and Australia went to tea with just three down. The game was drifting towards a draw unless something dramatic happened.

Wanting to try something different, Sourav decided to give my bowling a go. He hoped that a couple of breakthroughs might open up the game and he knew that the large Kolkata crowd would get behind us if they sensed an opportunity. I would always bowl for two or three overs when there were partnerships, and being an irregular bowler, I had licence to experiment. On the fifth-day pitch I decided to bowl leg-spin, pitching the ball in the rough with two left-handers at the crease. It was one of those rare days when the ball came out perfectly and I managed to take three quick wickets for the team in a five-over spell, including the wickets of in-form Matthew Hayden and the dangerous Adam Gilchrist.

However, the wicket that gave me the most satisfaction was that of Shane Warne. I tried to bowl him a googly and the ball ended up being a half-tracker, landing in the middle of the pitch before turning in to hit Warne plumb in front. Warne had perhaps misread the delivery and had first tried to cut before playing a half-pull. I had bamboozled one of the great spinners of all time!

We now had the opening we were after and Bhajji did the rest. When we finally took the last wicket of Glenn McGrath, with just three overs or so remaining in the match, the stadium went mad. Close to 100,000 spectators at Eden Gardens could not believe we had managed to win – and it was only the third time in history that a team had won after following on.

We celebrated for a long time after the match. The atmosphere in the changing room had changed completely after such an incredible win. There was a tremendous sense of positivity and we started to believe that we could go on to win the series. The Australians had collapsed in the face of sustained pressure. The myth of invincibility had been shattered. The series was now locked at 1–1, with all to play for in the third and final Test at Chennai.

The impact of the victory, celebrated all across the country, is perhaps illustrated by an incident involving SK Bansal, one of the umpires officiating in the Test. Mr Bansal later recounted to me that he had gone out for a meal after the match and his driver had mistakenly taken a wrong turn. He was heading the wrong way up a one-way street and was